

Math 241, F12
Quiz 1

Name: Answer
SSN: xxx-xx-

Instructions: There are totally 2 problems. You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer. No calculator is allowed in the quiz and exam.

Problem 1. (6 points) Find $3a + 2b$, $|a|$ and $|a - b|$ with the vectors $a = i + 2j - 3k$ and $b = -2i - 2j + 9k$.

$$\begin{aligned} 3a + 2b &= 3(i + 2j - 3k) + 2(-2i - 2j + 9k) \\ &= 3i + 6j - 9k - 4i - 4j + 18k \\ &= -i + 2j + 9k \end{aligned}$$

$$|a| = \sqrt{1^2 + 2^2 + (-3)^2} = \sqrt{14}$$

$$\begin{aligned} |a - b| &= |(i + 2j - 3k) - (-2i - 2j + 9k)| \\ &= |3i + 4j - 12k| \\ &= \sqrt{3^2 + 4^2 + (-12)^2} \\ &= \sqrt{169} \\ &= 13 \end{aligned}$$

Problem 2. (4 points) Find a unit vector that has the same direction as $\langle -2, 4, 4 \rangle$.

$$\text{let } a = \langle -2, 4, 4 \rangle$$

$$|a| = \sqrt{(-2)^2 + 4^2 + 4^2} = \sqrt{36} = 6$$

thus the unit vector having the same direction as a is given by

$$u = \frac{a}{|a|} = \frac{\langle -2, 4, 4 \rangle}{6} = \langle -\frac{1}{3}, \frac{2}{3}, \frac{2}{3} \rangle$$